

QIUHAO (BRAD) ZHAO

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Tourism geography & destination competitiveness · Urban sustainability and social equity · Spatiotemporal machine learning · Multimodal big data & large language models · Geographic information science (GIS)

EDUCATION

- Sep. 2022 – Present Ph.D. in Geology (Resources, Environment & Regional Planning)
Zhejiang University, School of Earth Sciences | Advisor: Prof. Pingbin Jin
GPA: 3.80/4.0 | Rank: 7/170 (4.1%)
- Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2022 B.S. in Human Geography & Urban-Rural Planning
Zhejiang University, School of Earth Sciences | GPA: 3.83/4.0 | Rank: 3/19 (15.8%)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Joint-Training Ph.D. Researcher — Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU) Nov. 2023 – May 2024
School of Hotel and Tourism Management | Co-supervisor: Prof. Hengyun Neil Li
- Applied multimodal big data, large language models, and spatiotemporal machine learning to study food-system sustainability and social equity in Hong Kong.
 - Web-scraped and processed 100k+ restaurant records; built an LLM-based menu-classification pipeline and spatiotemporal models revealing socioeconomic disparities across 18 districts.
- Research Assistant — Zhejiang University Aug. 2021 – Present
School of Earth Sciences | Advisor: Prof. Pingbin Jin
- Led research on tourism competitiveness, urban sustainability, and geospatial big-data analytics; integrated satellite imagery, street-view photos, social-media text, and POI data.
 - Designed machine-learning pipelines (XGBoost, LightGBM, MGWR) across 200+ destinations; first-authored 3 SSCI Q1 papers with 2 more under review.
- Intern — Hangzhou Zheda Scenic Tourism Planning & Design Co. Aug. 2020 – Present
- Participated in scenic-area master planning and spatial-design projects across Zhejiang Province.
 - Conducted field surveys, GIS mapping, and spatial analysis supporting tourism master-plan deliverables.

PUBLICATIONS

Published — First Author

- [1] Zhao, Q., Li, H., Wang, B., Xu, P., & Jin, P. (2025). Unveiling dynamic determinants of tourism competitiveness: analysis integrating multimodal data and spatiotemporal machine learning. *Journal of Travel Research*. (CAS Management Zone 1 Top, ABS 4, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 9.7, IF-5 = 11.0)
- [2] Zhao, Q., Xu, P., Wang, B., Wu, S., Wu, M., & Jin, P. (2024). Does location affect the mechanism of tourism competitiveness? Evidence from machine-learning analysis. *Tourism Management Perspectives*, 53, 101291. (CAS Management Zone 2, ABS 2, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.3, IF-5 = 9.1)
- [3] Zhao, Q., Jin, P., Wang, B., & Xu, P. (2023). Evaluation of rural tourism competitiveness based on multisource data and machine learning: a case study of Lin'an District, Hangzhou. *Progress in Geography*, 42(8), 1541–1555. (CSSCI, CSCD)

Under Review — First Author

- [4] Zhao, Q., Xu, P., & Jin, P. Social inequalities in sustainable dining access across Hong Kong: a spatiotemporal analysis using multimodal data and large language models. (Under Review)
- [5] Zhao, Q., Xu, P., & Jin, P. Seen or felt? How objective and perceived streetscape cues shape home-sharing performance. (Under Review)

Co-authored — Journal Articles

- [6] Li, X., Dogru, T., Zhao, Q., Liang, C., & Li, H. (2026). Tourism development in the context of ecological transformation: the role of governments' environmental protection attention. *Journal of Sustainable Tourism*. (CAS Management Zone 2, ABS 3, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.4, IF-5 = 10.6)
- [7] Wang, B., Zhao, Q., Zhang, Z., Xu, P., Tian, X., & Jin, P. (2025). Understanding the heterogeneity and dynamics of factors influencing tourist sentiment with online reviews. *Journal of Theoretical and Applied Electronic Commerce Research*, 20(1), 22. (CAS Zone 3, SSCI JCR Q2, IF = 4.5, IF-5 = 5.1)
- [8] Zou, Y., Zhao, Q., Wang, B., & Chen, G. (2025). Sentiment mining of online comments of sports venues: consumer satisfaction and its influencing factors. *PLoS One*, 20(5), e0319476. (CAS Multidisciplinary Sciences Zone 3, SCI JCR Q2, IF = 2.8, IF-5 = 3.1)

- [9] Zeng, X., Zhao, Q., & Feng, Y. (2025). Spatial layout of the elderly-care industry based on interpretable machine learning. *Journal of Zhejiang University (Science Edition)*, 52(3), 289–299. (Chinese Core, CSCD, IF = 1.4)
- [10] Xu, P., Zhou, G., Zhao, Q., Lu, Y., & Chen, J. (2024). Spatial-temporal dynamics and influencing factors of city-level carbon emission of mainland China. *Ecological Indicators*, 167, 112672. (CAS Environmental Sciences & Ecology Zone 1 Top, SCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.7, IF-5 = 8.5)
- [11] Qi, D., Wang, B., Zhao, Q., & Jin, P. (2024). Research on the spatial network structure of tourist flows in Hangzhou based on BERT-BiLSTM-CRF. *ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information*, 13(4), 139. (CAS Earth Sciences Zone 3, SCI JCR Q2, IF = 3.2, IF-5 = 3.5)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

IPAS 2025 — Int'l Conference on Planetary Actions for Sustainability University of Tokyo, Japan Poster	Nov. 2025
APacCHRIE 2025 — Asia Pacific Council on Hotel, Restaurant & Institutional Education Chiang Mai University, Thailand Oral	May 2025
IMPACT 2025 — International Symposium Hong Kong Polytechnic University Oral	Nov. 2024
National Tourism Geography Annual Conference Guangzhou, China Oral	Aug. 2024
National Human Geography Conference Shaanxi Normal University Oral	Aug. 2023
Zhejiang Geographical Society Annual Conference Zhejiang University Oral	Oct. 2022

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer reviewer (2023–present):

- Annals of Tourism Research (IF 8.1, ABS 4, CAS Zone 1 Top, SSCI JCR Q1) — 2 reviews
- Tourism Management (IF 14.5, ABS 4, CAS Zone 1 Top, SSCI JCR Q1) — 2 reviews
- Ecological Indicators (IF 8.7, CAS Zone 1 Top, SCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services (IF 13.7, ABS 2, CAS Zone 1 Top, SSCI JCR Q1) — 3 reviews
- International Journal of Hospitality Management (IF 8.3, ABS 3, CAS Zone 1 Top, SSCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- Tourism Management Perspectives (IF 8.3, ABS 2, CAS Zone 2, SSCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- Scientific Reports (IF 4.9, CAS Zone 3, SCI JCR Q1) — 2 reviews

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

President — Graduate Student Union, School of Earth Sciences, ZJU – Led a 30+ member council; organised 10+ academic and cultural events annually; liaised between students and faculty.	Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2023
Group Leader — Summer Social Practice Programme, ZJU – Led a 300+ student volunteer team delivering online rural teaching to high-school students at Changhua High School, Lin'an, Hangzhou.	Jun. 2020 – Sep. 2020

AWARDS & HONORS

National Scholarship for PhD Students, Zhejiang University	2025
Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Support Grant, Zhejiang University	2025
Qiusi Rising Star PhD Fellowship, Zhejiang University	2025
Hong Kong Government Scholarship, Research Grants Council	2024
Guo Xie Birong Scholarship, Zhejiang University	2023
Youth Excellent Paper Award, Geographical Society of Zhejiang Province	2022
Outstanding Bachelor Graduate, Zhejiang University	2022
Second Prize, 11th National Red Tourism Planning Competition (East China)	2021
Five-Star Volunteer, Zhejiang University	2021
Outstanding Individual in Summer Social Practice, Zhejiang University	2020
Third-Class Academic Scholarship, Zhejiang University	2020, 2021
Outstanding Student, Zhejiang University	2019, 2021

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Programming & GIS: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, Stata, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX

Methods: Machine learning, spatiotemporal modelling, multimodal data fusion, LLM applications

Languages: Chinese (native) | English (IELTS 7.0, CET-6 569) Interests: Fitness | Basketball | Boxing | Cooking | Baking